In June, the *Lawoe* was sailing occasionally to Kakinada. Even as the Swadeshi company was gasping for breath, BI had not given up on its cut-throat tactics, and went for the kill. It sent its men to Madras and other small ports between Madras and Tuticorin such as Pondicherry, Porto Novo, Thirumullaivasal and Nagapattinam to lure custom away from the Swadeshi steamers. They offered the time-tested bait of free railway freight and low rates for shipping to Colombo. *Swadesamitran*'s correspondent ('S.V.M.N.') who reported this said he had encountered some of these touts in Sirkazhi and Thittai.[32] To make matters worse, there was internal conflict, with rival claimants to the status of agents of SSNCo in Kakinada. When Sankarakumara Pillai and A.M.M. Hariharaputra Pillai, merchants of the town, shipped oil cakes they entered their names as agents at the customs office. But soon, one T.K. Nagaraja Rao, assistant secretary to SSNCo, went to the same office and substituted his name as agent. Though one Nalam Padmanabhan, a local merchant, was nominally the agent it was the above two merchants who were doing their best to ensure that the *Lawoe* called at Kakinada.[33] (Nalam Padmanabhan, described as a big merchant, had arranged to send the cargo of other merchants when the *Lawoe* first began sail to Kakinada in September 1908.[34])

Towards the end of June 1910, S.D. Krishna Aiyangar left for Calcutta accompanied by P.V. Ganapathi Pillai and returned two weeks later.[35] Such long trips were probably last-ditch efforts to save the company. Soon he left Tuticorin to start his legal practice in Madurai.[36]

According to his nephew, the Raja of Ramnad, Pandithurai Thevar had invested another Rs 10,000 in June 1910, taking his total contribution to Rs 1.5 lakh—another drop of water on parched land.[37] A letter from Vijayaraghavachari to Gooty P. Kesava Pillai reveals the desperation in the minds of many: 'I am sorry that I unwittingly annoyed you. It did not occur to me that it would be difficult for you to comply with my request. The Tuticorin business, chiefly & some other matters have placed me in a position financially which I did not expect.'[38] That even a man of